

1 Purpose and scope

This policy defines how engineering teams declare, run and close incidents for customer-facing and money-moving services. It complements the incident management standard and applies to every tier-1 service, including payments-api, ledger-service, processor-gateway and job-runner.

2 Severity levels

SEV1: customer money is at risk or a tier-1 service is unavailable. SEV2: a tier-1 service is degraded or a tier-2 service is down. SEV3: minor impact with a workaround.

3 Response

3.1 Escalation matrix

Response times are measured from the first alert.

Severity	Incident commander	First status update	Executive notice
SEV1	paged within 5 minutes	status page within 30 minutes	within 1 hour
SEV2	paged within 15 minutes	status page within 2 hours	next business day
SEV3	next business day	not required	not required

3.2 Customer communication

For SEV1 incidents that affect customer payments or refunds, the incident commander notifies affected merchants within 4 hours, using the template approved by the payments team lead. Refund corrections are announced only after finance has confirmed the totals.

4 Closing an incident

4.1 Postmortem

Every SEV1 and SEV2 incident gets a blameless postmortem within five business days. The postmortem names the owning squad, the timeline, the root cause and at most five actions, each with an owner and a due date.

4.2 Action tracking

Postmortem actions are reviewed weekly by the owning team's lead until they are done. An action that is more than 30 days overdue is escalated to the platform team.